

Word family: **otherwise**

Base word: otherwise

Part of speech: mainly **adverb**, sometimes functioning as a **sentence connector**

Related forms:

There is no large productive modern word family here. **Otherwise** is best learned as a standalone high-frequency word with several distinct constructions.

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **otherwise + would/could/might**

* **otherwise have done**

* **otherwise be**

* **otherwise known as**

* **say / think / believe otherwise**

* **unless otherwise stated**

* **unless otherwise specified**

* **or otherwise**

* **and otherwise**

* **otherwise occupied / engaged**

* **otherwise than** *(formal)*

Meaning in this passage

> Page by page, it captured small moments that might **otherwise** have slipped through the cracks.

Here, **otherwise** means:

if the scrapbook had not preserved them; if things had been different — 否則；不然的話

The implied meaning is:

> Without the album, those small moments might have been forgotten.

中文翻譯：

一頁一頁翻下去，裏面記錄的都是一些**如果不這樣保存下來，否則**就很容易從生活縫隙中溜走的小片段。

More naturally:

> 一頁一頁翻下去，裏面記錄的都是一些**如果不特別留住，就**很容易被遺忘的小片段。

So here:

otherwise = 如果不是這樣 / 否則的話

1. **otherwise = if not / if that does not happen — 否則 ; 不然**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> It captured small moments that might **otherwise** have slipped through the cracks.

它記錄了一些**否則可能會**被遺忘的小片段。

Practice 2

> Leave now; **otherwise**, you'll miss the train.

現在就走，**否則**你會錯過火車。

Practice 3

> Wear a coat. **Otherwise**, you'll get cold.

穿上外套，**不然**你會冷。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****otherwise = 如果前面的事情沒有發生或沒有照做，就會出現另一個結果****

2. **otherwise + would / could / might — 否則便會 / 可能會.....**

A very important pattern.

Practice 1

> We left early because we would **otherwise** have been late.

我們提早離開，因為**否則**便會遲到。

Practice 2

> She saved the document, which might **otherwise** have been lost.

她把文件儲存起來，因為它**否則可能會**遺失。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise + would/could/might = 表示如果沒有前面提到的情況，另一個結果便會或可能會發生

3. **otherwise have + past participle** — 否則本來會.....

This is the exact grammar pattern in your passage.

Practice 1

> The photos preserved memories that might **otherwise have faded**.

照片保存了那些**否則可能早已淡去**的回憶。

Practice 2

> The warning prevented an accident that could **otherwise have happened**.

那個警告避免了一場**否則可能已經發生**的意外。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise have done = 表示在另一種假設情況下，本來可能 / 會發生的過去結果

4. **otherwise = in other respects** — 在其他方面；除此之外

A major distinct sense.

Practice 1

> The room was small but **otherwise** comfortable.

房間很小，但**其他方面**都很舒適。

Practice 2

> He was tired but **otherwise** fine.

他有點累，但**除此之外**一切都好。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****otherwise = 除了已經提到的那一點之外，在其他方面****

5. ****otherwise + adjective — 除了某一點外，其他方面.....****

Practice 1

> It was a minor mistake in an ****otherwise excellent report****.

這是一份****其他方面都非常出色的報告****中的小錯誤。

Practice 2

> The scratch spoiled an ****otherwise perfect surface****.

那道刮痕破壞了****原本其他方面都完美的表面****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****otherwise + adjective/noun phrase = 表示除了某個已提及例外之外，其餘情況都具有該特質****

6. ****otherwise = differently / in another way — 用另一種方式；不同地****

Another major sense.

Practice 1

> I wouldn't have done it ****otherwise****.

我不會****用其他方式****做這件事。

Practice 2

> The instructions say one thing, but he chose to act ****otherwise****.

指示要求一種做法，但他選擇****以另一種方式行事****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****otherwise = 以不同方式；不是按照已提及的方法或情況****

7. ****otherwise known as — 又名；亦稱為****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Sodium chloride, **otherwise known as** salt, is widely used in cooking.

氯化鈉，**也就是俗稱的鹽**，廣泛用於烹飪。

Practice 2

> The city was once called Edo, **otherwise known as** old Tokyo in some historical discussions.

這座城市曾稱為江戶，在某些歷史討論中可理解為**東京的舊稱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise known as X = 也以 X 這個名稱為人所知；又名 X

8. **say / claim / think / believe otherwise — 說 / 認為情況並非如此**

This is a very important branch.

Practice 1

> Everyone thought the plan would fail, but she believed **otherwise**.

大家都認為計劃會失敗，但她**並不這樣認為**。

Practice 2

> The evidence suggests he knew about it, despite his claims **otherwise**.

證據顯示他知道此事，儘管他**聲稱並非如此**。

MCQ-ready definition:

think/say/believe otherwise = 認為或聲稱事實與前面所說的不同

9. **prove / show otherwise — 證明事實並非如此**

Practice 1

> I thought the task would be easy, but experience proved **otherwise**.

我本來以為任務很容易，但經驗**證明並非如此**。

Practice 2

> Unless the evidence shows **otherwise**, we will keep the original conclusion.

除非證據**顯示情況並非如此**，否則我們會保留原本結論。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****prove/show otherwise = 顯示真實情況與原先說法、假設或期待不同****

10. ****unless otherwise stated — 除非另有說明****

A very common formal instruction.

Practice 1

> All prices include tax unless ****otherwise stated****.

除非****另有說明****，所有價格均已包括稅項。

Practice 2

> Unless ****otherwise stated****, the rules apply to everyone.

除非****另有註明****，否則規則適用於所有人。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unless otherwise stated = 如果沒有另外作出不同說明，就按照目前的一般規則理解****

11. ****unless otherwise specified — 除非另有指定****

Practice 1

> Use black ink unless ****otherwise specified****.

除非****另有指定****，否則請使用黑色墨水。

Practice 2

> Meetings will be held online unless ****otherwise specified****.

除非**另有安排 / 指定**，否則會議將在網上舉行。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unless otherwise specified = 如果沒有特別指定其他方式，就採用目前所述方式****

12. ****unless otherwise agreed — 除非另有協議****

Practice 1

> Payment is due within 30 days unless ****otherwise agreed****.

除非**另有協議**，否則款項須在 30 天內支付。

Practice 2

> The meeting will begin at nine unless ****otherwise agreed****.

除非雙方**另有約定**，否則會議九點開始。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unless otherwise agreed = 如果各方沒有另外作出不同協議，就按現有安排進行****

13. ****or otherwise — 或其他情況；無論是否如此****

A flexible fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Everyone is welcome, experienced or ****otherwise****.

無論**有沒有經驗**，任何人都歡迎參加。

Practice 2

> The rule applies to all employees, permanent or ****otherwise****.

這條規則適用於所有員工，**不論是否屬於永久僱員**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X or otherwise = 無論是 X 還是其他相反或不同情況****

14. ****whether X or otherwise — 無論是否 X****

Practice 1

> The information must be reported, whether intentional or ****otherwise****.

無論是否出於故意，這項資料都必須申報。

Practice 2

> Everyone affected, directly or ****otherwise****, should be informed.

所有受到影響的人，無論是直接還是****其他形式的影響****，都應獲通知。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****whether X or otherwise = 無論是否屬於 X 的情況****

15. ****and otherwise — 以及其他方面 / 其他種類****

Practice 1

> The exhibition includes paintings, photographs, and ****otherwise**** unusual forms of art.

展覽包括畫作、照片以及****其他類型的****非一般藝術形式。

More idiomatically, this construction often appears after a category:

> The book discusses political, social, and ****otherwise**** sensitive issues.

這本書討論政治、社會以及****其他方面敏感的問題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****and otherwise = 以及其他沒有逐一系列出的方式或類別****

This use is more formal and context-dependent.

16. ****otherwise occupied / engaged — 忙於其他事情****

Practice 1

> I'm **otherwise engaged** this evening.

我今晚**另有事情要忙**。

Practice 2

> The manager was **otherwise occupied** and could not attend.

經理當時**正在處理其他事情**，所以無法出席。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise engaged/occupied = 正在做其他事情，因此無法參與目前所談的活動

17. **otherwise available / suitable / qualified** — 本來在其他方面.....

Practice 1

> The error affected an **otherwise suitable candidate**.

這個錯誤影響了一位**其他方面都很合適的候選人**。

Practice 2

> The rule excludes people who are **otherwise qualified**.

這條規則排除了一些**在其他方面本來完全合資格的人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise + adjective = 除了某個例外因素外，本來具備該形容詞所描述的條件

18. **otherwise than** — 除了.....以外；以不同於.....的方式

Formal and much less common.

Practice 1

> The information must not be used **otherwise than** for research purposes.

這些資料不得**以研究用途以外的方式**使用。

Practice 2

> The funds cannot be spent **otherwise than** as agreed.

這筆款項不得**以雙方同意以外的方式**使用。

MCQ-ready definition:

otherwise than = formal: in any way different from / except as

中文：

除.....之外；以不同於.....的方式

For most learners, **except / differently from / in any other way** will be more natural in everyday English.

Important distinction 1: **otherwise** = 否則 vs **otherwise** = 其他方面

These are the two biggest senses.

Consequence

> Hurry up; **otherwise**, we'll be late.

快點，**否則**我們會遲到。

Other respects

> The room was small but **otherwise** comfortable.

房間很小，但**其他方面**很舒適。

Same word, very different logic.

Important distinction 2: **otherwise** vs **or else**

otherwise

neutral and works in formal and written English.

or else

more conversational; sometimes sounds like a warning or threat.

> Leave now; otherwise you'll be late.

現在走，否則會遲到。

> Give it back, or else!

把它還來，否則有你看！

So **or else** can carry a much stronger tone.

Important distinction 3: **otherwise** vs **if not**

Very close in conditional use.

> Wear a coat; otherwise you'll be cold.

≈

> Wear a coat. If not, you'll be cold.

But **otherwise** is smoother and more compact.

Important distinction 4: **otherwise** vs **alternatively**

otherwise

can mean “if not” or “in a different way.”

alternatively

introduces another option.

> Take the train. Alternatively, you can drive.

你可以坐火車；或者也可以駕車。

You normally cannot replace this with **otherwise** if you simply mean “another option.”

Important distinction 5: **otherwise** vs **differently**

differently

specifically describes a different manner.

otherwise

can mean differently, but also has several broader uses.

> I would do it differently.

我會用不同方式做。

> I wouldn't do it otherwise.

我不會用其他方式做。

The second can imply strong satisfaction with the chosen way.

Important distinction 6: **otherwise vs however**

otherwise

= if not / in other respects / differently.

however

= nevertheless / but.

> He was tired but otherwise fine.

他很累，但其他方面沒事。

> He was tired; however, he continued working.

他很累；不過他仍繼續工作。

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 7: **otherwise vs instead**

instead

means one thing replaces another.

otherwise

often describes what would happen if the first thing did not happen.

> We stayed home instead.

我們改為留在家。

> We stayed home because otherwise we'd get wet.

我們留在家，因為**否則**會淋濕。

Important distinction 8: **otherwise + modal perfect**

Your passage uses:

> might **otherwise have slipped**

Structure:

modal + otherwise + have + past participle

Examples:

* would otherwise have failed

* could otherwise have disappeared

* might otherwise have been forgotten

This usually describes a **hypothetical alternative past**.

Important distinction 9: **say otherwise vs say something else**

say otherwise

say that the opposite/different situation is true.

say something else

say some other content altogether.

> The evidence says otherwise.

證據顯示並非如此。

This does **not** simply mean “the evidence says another sentence.”

Important distinction 10: **otherwise known as vs also known as**

They are practically equivalent in this construction.

> sodium chloride, otherwise known as salt

> sodium chloride, also known as salt

Both mean:

又稱為 / 亦稱為

Also known as is often simpler and more common for learners.

Important distinction 11: **otherwise fine**

A very common pattern:

> I'm tired, but otherwise fine.

This means:

除了累之外，其他方面都沒事

It does **not** mean:

> 「否則我很好」

So the Chinese translation must change according to the grammatical function.

Important distinction 12: **otherwise + adjective often creates an exception structure**

> an otherwise excellent essay

means:

一篇除了某個已提及問題外，其他方面都很出色的文章

It does not mean simply:

> another excellent essay

This is a common advanced-reading trap.

Important distinction 13: **or otherwise**

> employed or otherwise

does not usually mean:

> employed or “something random”

It means:

whether employed or not / regardless of employment status

The exact opposite/alternative is understood from context.

Important distinction 14: **unless otherwise stated**

This is a formulaic formal expression.

The logic is:

> follow this rule **unless someone explicitly gives a different rule**

So:

otherwise = in a different way

inside this construction, even though the whole phrase naturally translates as:

除非另有說明

Family-extension note

****Otherwise**** has four especially important modern branches:

1. ****if not / or else****

- * otherwise you'll be late
- * might otherwise have disappeared

2. ****in other respects****

- * tired but otherwise fine
- * an otherwise excellent report

3. ****differently / the opposite****

- * think otherwise
- * prove otherwise
- * act otherwise

4. ****formal “other arrangement” constructions****

- * unless otherwise stated
- * unless otherwise agreed
- * or otherwise
- * otherwise engaged

For learners, the word should ****not**** be memorized with only one Chinese translation.

Depending on context:

****otherwise = 否則****

****otherwise = 其他方面****

****otherwise = 不同地 / 以其他方式****

****otherwise = 並非如此****

****otherwise = 另有.....****

Master comparison

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otherwise (consequence)	否則；不然	if not	
otherwise + would/could/might	否則會 / 可能會	alternative result	
otherwise have done	否則本來會.....	hypothetical past	
otherwise (other respects)	其他方面	apart from exception	
otherwise excellent	其他方面都很出色的	one exception	
otherwise (differently)	以其他方式	differently	
otherwise known as	又稱；亦稱	another name	
think otherwise	不這樣認為	think differently	
say otherwise	聲稱並非如此	claim opposite	
prove otherwise	證明並非如此	show opposite	
unless otherwise stated	除非另有說明	different instruction	
unless otherwise specified	除非另有指定	different specification	
unless otherwise agreed	除非另有協議	different agreement	
or otherwise	無論是否 / 或其他情況	alternative state	
otherwise engaged	另有事情	occupied elsewhere	
otherwise qualified	其他方面均合資格	except one factor	
otherwise than	除.....之外；以不同方式	formal alternative	

For your original sentence

> Page by page, it captured small moments that might ****otherwise**** have slipped through the cracks.

Here:

****otherwise = 如果沒有這本相簿把它們保存下來，否則 / 本來可能.....****

The hidden conditional is:

> ****If the album had not captured those moments, they might have been forgotten.****

So:

> might ****otherwise**** have slipped through the cracks

> = ****否則可能就被遺忘了****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 一頁一頁翻下去，裏面記錄的都是一些****如果不特別留住，就很容易被遺忘****的小片段。

This is a particularly useful advanced structure because ****otherwise**** compresses an entire unstated condition into one word.